

Evander Theron — Emotion Affinity Strings

Player handout · proposed THREADCAST mechanics

Evander senses emotion as something almost tangible: the anxiety beneath a confident voice, affection mixed with resentment, a trace of hope in someone who says they have given up. When he casts, small masks appear around him. Their expressions shift with the emotion he is touching.

His affinity can **perceive, intensify, quiet, redirect, conceal, connect, and release emotions that already exist**. It cannot manufacture a genuine feeling with no basis in the target. It cannot create love, loyalty, beliefs, memories, or a relationship. Emotion may influence a person's choices, but Evander does **not** get to choose their actions for them.

Using the Strings

- **PL** is Power Level. Evander chooses a PL he can cast and may cast at a lower one.
- **TP** is Tension Points added **when he attempts** a String, successful or not. **DC** is its Thread Check target. The attribute beside each String is its Thread Check attribute.
- Unless stated otherwise, casting takes a **Major Action**, targets someone Evander can perceive within **30 ft**, and cannot pass through a solid barrier. A **Reaction** uses his reaction for that round.
- He can concentrate on only **one ongoing String at a time**. Otherwise, concentration follows the campaign's normal rules.
- A **willing target** may accept an effect without a save. An **unwilling target** makes a **RES save against that row's DC**. Success prevents the effect on that target. Each unwilling target of a group String saves separately.
- If an effect says **Harmony** or **Discord**, use those terms as defined by THREADCAST. They do not stack with another source of the same benefit or penalty on the same roll.
- **One round** means until the start of Evander's next turn. Longer durations run from the time of casting.
- Where a String requires an existing emotional **seed**, Evander must work from something the target presently feels, even faintly. If it is absent, the effect fails on that target; the cast still costs TP. Sensing a seed is not proof that the feeling is deep, freely chosen, or permanent.
- A String that counters an **active emotional magical effect** requires a Thread Check against the **higher of its row's DC or the opposing cast's DC**. If that cast has no stated DC, use its caster's Thread Check result.
- No String in this handout deals direct VP damage. Its combat value is morale, composure, coordination, and resistance. No String forces suicide, a confession, betrayal, or a specific attack.

Passive sensitivity: Evander can often notice a strong nearby emotion without casting, particularly in conversation. This gives him impressions, not exact thoughts or infallible truth. In a crowd, overlapping feelings can become exhausting. Echo gives him a controlled way to identify and act on what he senses.

1. The Echo String — THS

Domain: Perceive and amplify an existing emotion.

Mask: Several faces cycle rapidly before matching the feeling Evander has found.

Echo is the foundation of the affinity. Evander selects **one emotion actually present** in each target—fear, sympathy, frustration, hope, affection, or another specific feeling—and makes it harder to ignore. He cannot use Echo to select an emotion merely because he wishes the person felt it.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Sense the strongest immediately felt emotion in one creature within 15 ft. Evander may leave it untouched or amplify it until the start of his next turn. An unwilling target that fails its RES save has Discord on its next check to conceal or maintain composure against that emotion during the duration. Echo gives Evander a feeling, not its cause.
2	2 / 13	Identify one emotion present even if it is not dominant in one creature within 30 ft. , then amplify it for 3 rounds while concentrating . On a failed save, the target has Discord on its next attack, Thread Check, or social check that directly conflicts

		with that emotion; the penalty is spent after one roll. Evander names which kind of roll when casting.
3	4 / 15	Affect up to two creatures within 30 ft , choosing an emotion separately for each that each actually feels. For 3 rounds while concentrating , each unwilling target that fails its save has Discord on the first relevant attack, Thread Check, or social check it makes each round . The chosen check type must relate to the amplified emotion.
4	6 / 17	Affect up to three creatures within 30 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Evander can identify one concealed but presently felt emotion in each, without learning the memory or reason behind it. Each failed save applies the PL 3 penalty. A target that succeeds still knows what it feels; Evander simply cannot amplify it.
5	9 / 19	Amplify one emotion already shared by up to five creatures within 30 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Each unwilling target saves separately. A failed save

		gives Discord on its first relevant attack or Thread Check each round . If fewer than five creatures actually feel the selected emotion, the effect reaches only those who do. It cannot manufacture panic in an otherwise unafraid crowd.
--	--	---

Double edge: Echo made a frightened sparring opponent collapse, but that was an **uncontrolled awakening**, not a routine PL 1 result. It also explains the earlier incidents: existing sympathy became easier for a teacher to act on, a friend's buried hope grew louder, and frustration in arguments intensified.

2. The Hush String — CTR

Domain: Lower the intensity of an existing emotion without resolving its cause.

Mask: Expressions become still and gradually blank.

Hush can make fear or grief manageable for a time. It cannot make the threat disappear, heal an injury, or convince someone that what happened does not matter. **Veil** hides a feeling from observers; **Hush** actually quiets what the person experiences.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	By touch , lower the intensity of one emotion in Evander or a willing creature for 1 minute . The target remains aware of the feeling and its cause, but has Harmony on its next check to keep composure despite that emotion .
2	2 / 13	Affect one creature within 15 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . A willing target can ignore Discord on one roll caused

		specifically by mundane fear, anger, or distress during the duration. An unwilling target that fails its save instead finds one emotion muted and has Discord on its next social check that depends on expressing it convincingly.
3	4 / 15	Quiet an emotion in up to two creatures within 20 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating. A willing target may immediately make a new RES save against one ongoing emotional magical effect causing that emotion; success suspends that effect's emotional penalty on them for one round, but does not end its caster's String.
4	6 / 17	Quiet an emotion in up to three creatures within 30 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating. For one willing target, Evander may instead contest an active magical fear, rage, or despair effect and suppress its emotional effects on that target for the duration of Hush. This does not remove non-emotional effects or protect other targets.
5	9 / 19	For 1 minute while

		concentrating , quiet one specified emotion in up to five willing creatures within 30 ft . Each can function through that feeling and ignores the first instance of Discord each round caused solely by that emotion . This does not remove general Discord from injury, exhaustion, or unrelated magic.
--	--	---

Double edge: When Hush ends, the underlying feeling may return. It is a way to get through a moment, not a substitute for safety, conversation, or mourning.

3. The Dread String — POT

Domain: Heighten fear and awareness of a threat.

Mask: Screaming faces turn toward the affected target.

Dread needs **fear or apprehension already present**. It may attach that fear to something the target already understands as threatening, including Evander in a confrontation. It cannot make an unafraid stranger believe an invented monster is in the room or implant a false memory of danger.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Amplify a creature's existing apprehension within 30 ft for one round . On a failed RES save, it has Discord on its next attack against the thing it fears . It chooses its actions normally.
2	2 / 13	Intensify existing fear in one creature within 30 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . On a failed save, it cannot take reactions while the effect

		lasts; it remains free to move, attack, or seek cover.
3	4 / 15	Affect up to two frightened creatures within 30 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Each that fails its save cannot take reactions and has Discord on its first attack each round against the source of its fear . The target may still decide to stand and fight.
4	6 / 17	Affect up to three creatures within 30 ft that already fear a recognizable threat. For 3 rounds while concentrating , each failed save imposes the PL 3 effects; in addition, it has Discord on one check each round to maintain a coordinated formation or follow an order that brings it closer to that threat .
5	9 / 19	Amplify an existing fear shared by up to five creatures within 40 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Failed saves impose PL 4's effects. An affected creature may retreat if its player or GM judges that appropriate, but Evander does not choose its route or command it to flee .

Double edge: Nikandros would see a way to break enemy morale. Evander knows that the

people in that formation remain people, even when he can feel exactly where they are afraid.

4. The Valor String — THS

Domain: Strengthen an existing wish to continue despite fear.

Mask: Determined faces gather near those Evander encourages.

Valor does **not** remove fear or convince someone that danger is imaginary. A willing target must have some real resolve, hope, duty, or desire to protect someone. The target still decides whether to fight.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	By touch, strengthen the resolve of Evander or one willing creature for 1 minute . The target gains Harmony on its next check to act despite fear .
2	2 / 13	One willing creature within 20 ft gains Harmony on its next RES save against fear before the end of Evander's next turn. If it is already affected by fear, it may immediately make another RES save against that effect; this does not end the magic on anyone else.
3	4 / 15	Up to two willing creatures within 30 ft gain steadied resolve for 3 rounds while Evander concentrates . Once each during the duration, they may ignore Discord caused specifically by fear on one attack or Thread Check.

4	6 / 17	Up to three willing creatures within 30 ft gain the PL 3 benefit. Each also gains Harmony on its first save against fear during the duration. Harmony is spent after that save.
5	9 / 19	For 1 minute while concentrating , rally up to five willing creatures within 40 ft . Each can ignore one instance of fear-based Discord per round and has Harmony on one RES save against fear during the duration. They still perceive threats and can choose to retreat.

Double edge: Valor is not an order to be brave for Evander's sake. It makes room for someone's own reasons to keep going.

5. The Fury String — POT

Domain: Intensify existing anger, indignation, or aggression.

Mask: Snarling faces form, their edges beginning to crack.

Fury cannot select a new victim for the target's hatred. If Evander wants to focus someone's anger, that person must already have a reason to be angry at that subject. **No Fury effect forces a target to attack an ally.**

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Intensify one creature's existing anger within 30 ft for one round . On a failed RES save, it has Discord on its next check to speak calmly, de-escalate, or conceal that anger . A willing target may accept

		the effect without a save.
2	2 / 13	For 3 rounds while concentrating , a willing angry target within 20 ft may add 1d6 damage to one attack against a creature it was already opposed to. After that attack, it has Discord on its next check to notice a different threat before its next turn ends. An unwilling target that fails its save receives only that Discord penalty, not the bonus damage.
3	4 / 15	Affect up to two angry creatures within 30 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . A willing target gains the PL 2 attack bonus once during the duration . An unwilling target that fails its save has Discord on its first attack each round against anyone other than the subject of its existing anger . It can still choose whom to attack.
4	6 / 17	Affect up to three creatures within 30 ft with an existing source of anger. For 3 rounds while concentrating , a willing target may add 2d6 damage to one attack during the duration , then cannot take reactions until

		its next turn. An unwilling target that fails its save has Discord on its first attack or composure-related Thread Check each round while acting against that anger.
5	9 / 19	Heighten anger already shared by up to five creatures within 40 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Each unwilling target saves separately. Failed saves impose PL 4's Discord effect; willing targets may each use PL 4's bonus once . Evander cannot use this to specify whom any of them attacks.

Double edge: Fury can give anger purpose or narrow someone's world until they miss everything else. Evander knows how often anger has hidden hurt in him.

6. The Sorrow String — THS

Domain: Bring existing grief, longing, or absence to the surface.

Mask: Crying faces shed translucent drops that disappear before reaching the ground.

Sorrow needs a **real present sense of loss**. It does not manufacture a tragedy, identify a missing person's location, tell Evander whether someone is alive, or restore fading memories. He can sense the weight of an absence without knowing its story.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Sense whether one creature within 15 ft presently carries grief or longing. Evander may amplify that feeling for one round . On a failed RES save,

		the target has Discord on its next check to maintain cheerful composure or conceal the grief.
2	2 / 13	One grieving creature within 30 ft feels the weight of its loss for 3 rounds while Evander concentrates. On a failed save, it has Discord on its next attack or Thread Check made in anger during the duration. Its grief does not tell Evander what happened.
3	4 / 15	Affect up to two creatures within 30 ft that are already carrying loss. For 3 rounds while concentrating , each failed save gives Discord on the first attack or Thread Check it makes each round while trying to ignore that loss. This does not stop it from choosing to act.
4	6 / 17	Affect up to three grieving creatures within 30 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating. Each failed save imposes the PL 3 penalty. Once during the duration, an affected creature attempting to maintain an emotionally driven magical effect must make a new concentration check under

		the campaign's rules; Sorrow does not automatically break it.
5	9 / 19	Bring a shared, existing loss to the surface in up to five creatures within 40 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Each saves separately against the PL 4 effects. A group with no shared loss cannot be made to grieve together by this cast.

Double edge: Evander knows what it is to be suspended between grief and hope. Sorrow can make avoidance impossible for a moment; it cannot supply the answers he never received.

7. The Rapture String — POT

Domain: Amplify existing joy, anticipation, pleasure, or exhilaration.

Mask: Laughing faces turn and spin around Evander.

Rapture needs something the target is **already pleased or excited about**. It cannot make abuse enjoyable, cure pain or injury, or establish that someone consents to something because they feel good. Its dangerous edge is reckless exhilaration, not a clinical condition imposed by a spell.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Strengthen a present spark of joy in Evander or one creature within 15 ft for one round . A willing target gains Harmony on its next check to act despite discouragement . An unwilling target that fails its save has Discord on its next check to remain outwardly composed .

2	2 / 13	For 3 rounds while concentrating , strengthen one willing target's existing excitement within 20 ft . Once during the duration, it gains Harmony on an attack, performance, or movement-related check it chooses. This does not restore VP or suppress an injury's mechanical effects.
3	4 / 15	Affect up to two creatures within 30 ft that already feel joy or anticipation. A willing target gains PL 2's benefit. An unwilling target that fails its save has Discord on its next check requiring patient observation or restraint during the 3-round concentration duration.
4	6 / 17	Affect up to three creatures within 30 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Willing targets each gain Harmony on one qualifying roll per round; after using it, each has Discord on its next check requiring caution before the end of its following turn . Unwilling targets that fail saves suffer only that caution penalty once per round, not the benefit.
5	9 / 19	Amplify joy or exhilaration already shared by up to five

		creatures within 40 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating. Each uses PL 4's effect. Evander cannot make an enemy delight in harming someone or make any target disregard an obvious mortal danger automatically.
--	--	---

Double edge: Rapture can make a hard moment bearable or encourage someone to ignore a warning. Evander must distinguish sharing joy from pushing another person past their judgment.

8. The Shame String — THS

Domain: Heighten existing guilt, embarrassment, or self-consciousness.

Mask: Faces turn inward or cover their own eyes.

Shame follows **what the target believes** they should regret. It is not a truth spell. It cannot establish objective guilt, reveal whether a statement is false, or affect someone who feels no shame about the subject Evander is trying to touch.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Sense whether one creature within 15 ft is presently feeling guilt or embarrassment. If Evander amplifies it, an unwilling target that fails its RES save has Discord on its next check to maintain a confident social presentation before his next turn. He does not learn what it regrets.
2	2 / 13	Amplify a real self-conscious feeling in one creature within 30 ft for 3 rounds while

		concentrating. On a failed save, it has Discord on its next social check to deceive, intimidate, or assert certainty. A truthful, unrepentant person may still be unaffected.
3	4 / 15	Affect up to two creatures within 30 ft with existing guilt or shame. Each that fails its save has Discord on its first social check or Thread Check made under public scrutiny each round for 3 rounds while Evander concentrates.
4	6 / 17	Affect up to three creatures within 30 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating. Failed saves impose PL 3's penalty; a target affected while threatening or interrogating someone also cannot take reactions until its next turn as its confidence falters. It is still free to speak or attack.
5	9 / 19	Amplify a shared sense of responsibility or embarrassment in up to five creatures within 40 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating. Each failed save imposes PL 4's effects. The String cannot make an innocent person confess to a crime or force an actual

		wrongdoer to feel remorse they do not possess.
--	--	--

Double edge: Evander's own guilt is not a measure of what he deserves. Shame is particularly unreliable as evidence, even when the target's reaction looks convincing.

9. The Veil String — CTR

Domain: Mask an emotional signal without altering the feeling beneath it.

Mask: One expression slides over another like a false face.

Veil interferes with **emotion-based perception**, magical or mundane. It does not make a target invisible, change their words, or give them a perfect poker face. The protected person still experiences the emotion fully. A magical observer seeking to pierce Veil contests its Thread Check against Evander's successful casting result.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	For 1 minute , Evander masks one of his own emotions from passive emotional sensing. An observer still sees ordinary physical signs unless he conceals them himself.
2	2 / 13	By touch , mask one specified emotion in Evander or one willing creature for 10 minutes . A magical observer must win the contest above to sense that emotion. Other emotions remain readable.
3	4 / 15	Mask the emotional signatures of up to two willing creatures within 15 ft for 10 minutes while concentrating . Choose one emotion per creature . Moving beyond 15 ft ends

		that creature's protection.
4	6 / 17	For 10 minutes while concentrating , mask up to three willing creatures within 30 ft . For each, Evander may make one strong emotion appear as a different emotion the person genuinely also feels . He cannot fabricate a feeling absent from them. An observer who wins the magical contest detects the masking.
5	9 / 19	For 1 hour while concentrating , conceal the emotional signatures of up to five willing creatures within 30 ft from supernatural emotional perception. Observers can still draw ordinary conclusions from speech, behavior, and circumstances; the String is not immunity to being understood.

Double edge: Veil is the difference between not wanting someone to know you are afraid and not being afraid. It can protect a private feeling without helping Evander face it.

10. The Concord String — CTR

Domain: Connect emotional states already present in more than one person.

Mask: Several masks settle into the same expression at once.

Concord **shares or distributes a feeling**. It does not create a relationship between linked creatures, send thoughts, transmit memories, or allow Evander to issue commands through a link. A willing participant can choose to leave a Concord link on their turn; an unwilling one saves as specified.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Link Evander and one willing creature he touches for 1 minute while concentrating . Each can sense whether the other is presently calm, distressed, or encouraged. They learn no reason or thoughts. Either may end their participation.
2	3 / 14	Link up to three willing creatures within 15 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Once during the duration, one participant may let another participant who is afraid use their steadiness, granting Harmony on that person's next RES save against fear . The sharing target must genuinely feel some steadiness or resolve.
3	5 / 16	Link up to four willing creatures within 20 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Once per round, Evander may distribute one participant's acute fear among the others: that participant ignores one fear-based instance of Discord , while one other willing participant accepts Discord on its next composure-related check. No one can be assigned

		that burden without consent.
4	7 / 18	Link a creature within 30 ft that is already afraid to up to two other creatures within 15 ft of it . Unwilling recipients each make a RES save. Those that fail experience an echo of that existing fear for one round and have Discord on their next attack or Thread Check . The original creature is not relieved of its fear, and no participant receives images or memories.
5	10 / 20	For 3 rounds while concentrating , link up to five creatures within 30 ft around one emotion at least one of them already feels. Each unwilling recipient saves. Those who fail share a diluted impression and have Discord on their first check each round directly conflicting with that emotion ; willing recipients instead may share one participant's steadiness for Harmony on one relevant RES save during the duration. Each creature receives only the effect relevant to its participation; the link cannot make them a hive mind.

Double edge: Concord can help someone feel less alone. Used without consent, it turns

another person's private fear into a weapon.

11. The Devotion String — THS

Domain: Strengthen an authentic bond that **already exists**.

Mask: Paired faces orbit each other without merging.

Devotion cannot create love, friendship, trust, obedience, or loyalty. It can help someone act on care they genuinely already feel. Its benefits below require **willing participants with a real bond**, not merely two people Evander wants to bring together. A familial bond can exist alongside anger and distance; the String does not erase those complications.

Devotion can suggest that *some* genuine attachment exists. It **cannot** tell Evander its exact nature, prove that a relationship is healthy, or answer whether anyone freely chooses to stay now.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	By touching two willing creatures , Evander can sense whether a genuine bond of care presently exists between them, without identifying its nature or strength. If it does, one gains Harmony on its next check to protect or comfort the other within 1 minute.
2	2 / 13	Strengthen an existing bond between two willing creatures within 15 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Once during the duration, either gains Harmony on a RES save against an effect that would make it abandon or harm the other against its wishes . This does not make either

		incapable of disagreeing.
3	4 / 15	Strengthen the bond between two willing creatures within 20 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Once per round, one may use a Reaction to move up to 5 ft along an open path toward the other when the other is threatened. This movement does not prevent the threat or ignore reactions from enemies.
4	6 / 17	Affect up to three willing creatures within 30 ft who each have an authentic bond with at least one other participant. For 3 rounds while concentrating , each gains Harmony on one RES save against coercion, fear of losing a participant, or magical pressure to betray a participant . Each may use that benefit once.
5	9 / 19	For 1 minute while concentrating , strengthen an existing network of care among up to five willing creatures within 30 ft . Each may use Harmony once per round on a check to protect, reach, or remain true to another participant . Devotion cannot compel one participant to sacrifice

		themselves, and leaving the String's range ends their benefit.
--	--	--

Double edge: If Devotion responds, there was something real for Evander to strengthen. It still cannot settle his deeper fear that he may have influenced how someone *expressed* that feeling. Magic is not a substitute for asking them.

12. The Catharsis String — CTR

Domain: Let an overwhelming emotion be experienced and released instead of amplified, buried, or concealed.

Mask: Faces move through genuine expressions, then dissolve rather than settling on one.

Catharsis primarily works with **willing creatures**. It is not compelled confession or instant treatment for trauma. It does not remove a meaningful attachment, erase a memory, cure an illness, or tell someone that grief is over. Its high-PL combat use is to help a willing person break the immediate hold of **magical** emotional effects.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	By touch , help Evander or one willing creature acknowledge one overwhelming present emotion for 1 minute without trying to suppress it. The target gains Harmony on its next check to remain composed while expressing that feeling honestly . It chooses what, if anything, to say.
2	2 / 13	Help one willing creature within 15 ft release the immediate intensity of fear, anger, or grief over 1 minute . It may immediately make a new RES save against one ongoing

		mundane emotional penalty or magical emotional effect affecting it. Success removes that penalty from the creature for one round; its underlying feeling and the magic's source remain.
3	4 / 15	Help one willing creature within 20 ft confront and release an active magical fear, rage, or despair effect. Contest that active cast. On success, end its emotional effect on that creature. Its non-emotional effects and effects on other creatures remain. Catharsis does not restore VP.
4	6 / 17	Help up to two willing creatures within 20 ft face the same ongoing emotional magical effect. Contest the active cast once; on success, end its emotional effects on both. Alternatively, over 10 minutes with one willing creature, help it work through an intense nonmagical emotion enough to gain Harmony on its next check to act without being overwhelmed by that emotion. The person decides what the feeling means afterward.
5	9 / 19	For 1 minute while

		concentrating, guide up to three willing creatures within 30 ft through an overwhelming emotion. Each immediately gains a new RES save against one ongoing emotional magical effect; Evander may contest one active source to end that source's emotional effect on up to three of them. Once during the minute, each may ignore one instance of Discord caused solely by that emotion. This does not erase grief or prevent it from returning.
--	--	--

Double edge: Catharsis asks Evander to do what Hush and Veil let him avoid: recognize the feeling and allow it to pass through without turning it into a weapon.